INC-2026-02-17: Double-entry ledger recording every authorisation, capture a degradation

Northwind Payments · SEV1 · service ledger-service · author j.barros

Started 2026-02-17T22:00:00Z · detected 2026-02-17T22:11:00Z · resolved 2026-02-17T22:00:00Z

Customer impact

Ledger writes failed for 22 minutes, which blocked all captures. Authorisations continued but could not be recorded.

Root cause

The primary Postgres volume reached 94% capacity because an archival job had silently failed for eleven days. Write latency degraded until the ledger began rejecting transactions.

Affected services

ledger-service, payment-gateway, settlement-worker, merchant-portal, webhook-dispatcher. Downstream services were affected through their dependency on ledger-service.

Timeline (UTC)

22:00 — First symptoms observed on ledger-service.

22:11 — Alert pages the on-call engineer for ledger-service.

22:19 — Cause identified and mitigation begins.

22:00 — Service returns to baseline; incident resolved.

Action items

• Require a load test for configuration changes of this class.

• Review the third-party contract for change notification.

• Add an integration test covering the failure mode.